



of Florida's Blue Key leadership society had been ordered to admit women by the Florida Board of Education. The president of Blue Key at that time was Jim Reinman of Melbourne. He was quoted in the Miami Herald, saying, "In the past, people felt we had the right to restrict membership, and we were under no compulsion to change."¹²² On November 5, 1974, UM's chapter of Omicron Delta Kappa (ODK), national fraternity for scholarship and leadership, tapped its first female member, Alumni Relations Director Jenny Coburn. The national female equivalent of ODK, however, continued its policy of excluding males from membership. Thus Mortar Board which had once been UM's Nu Kappa Tau maintained its traditional integrity in the face of the storm. Still there was no word from Washington. Dean Frederick Lewis of the Law School was guest speaker at the spring tapping luncheon of 1974, and made the observation that should the government order Iron Arrow to accept women for membership, "it would not be the first time in history that an Indian tribe was put asunder from Washington."

Wednesday, June 4, 1975, brought the Miami Herald headlines, "Sex Discrimination Banned in Schools." HEW had established its policies regarding athletics, scholarships, employment, and many other activities. "While college social fraternities and sororities are exempt, groups such as business and professional fraternities and sororities and honor societies may not discriminate by sex."¹²³ Whether 50 years of Iron Arrow tradition would weather the storm without major structural damage was thrown into doubt.



¹²² The Miami Herald, March 24, 1975.

¹²³ The Miami Herald, June 4, 1975.





BITS AND PIECES

The first Iron Arrow tapping seen live on television occurred February 21, 1973. On that evening's Ralph Renick Report, WTVJ's Sports Director, Bob Halloran, was tapped during the broadcast of the 6:00 p.m. news. An audience of thousands watched as Chief Rhea Warren, Chuck Foreman, Ray Bellamy, and Burgess Owens tapped the sportscaster while longtime Iron Arrow member Ralph Renick looked on.

Another Iron Arrow member was making history in quite another way. Former student-body President Jim Fleming is famous to thousands at the University of Miami for his ability to manipulate a crowd as UM head cheerleader. Most observers felt Fleming had reached his peak when he threw his shoulder out of joint one night while leading a cheer before a thunderous Orange Bowl crowd. Others thought it might have been the time he and the Band of the Hour struck up a mock funeral dirge for Notre Dame's Ara Parseghian in 1967: "Cheer up, Ara, the worst is yet to come." But alumnus Fleming topped both occasions when Miami police arrested him on the Orange Bowl sidelines in 1973 for "inciting a riot." His crime? Leading the Orange Bowl crowd in the famous UM Yamma-Yamma cheer. Says Fleming, "They even read me my 'rights.'"

One of the most memorable of the society's social events was a tribal celebration at the home of Dr. Henry Field in Coconut Grove on May 20, 1973. The home of the famous archaeologist, explorer and anthropologist is located on Main Highway in the heart of Miami's historical bayfront community. Born into a prominent Chicago family, famous as the founders of a department store chain and the Chicago Sun, Field during his lifetime has met secretly with Lawrence of Arabia and explored the forbidden burial chambers of Egypt's 3,400-year-old tomb of King Tut.¹²⁴

Before his death in 1973, Academy Award nominee and Iron Arrow member Michael Dunn starred in the film "Ship of Fools." Returning for Homecoming, 1967, the celebrated UM alumnus was tapped during half-time ceremonies in the Orange Bowl stadium by Chief Tom Spencer.



¹²⁴ Tropic Magazine, The Miami Herald, 1975.





ACTIVITIES



PIGEON KEY

If you follow U.S. 1 down its narrow, cracked roadway, you will discover the mixture of sky and sea that makes the Florida Keys unique. Just below Marathon the road strikes out across a sun-bleached, broken expanse called “Seven Mile Bridge.” If you travel the bridge at sunset, royal purple clouds over Florida Bay will slice the dying minutes of the day into orange and red ribbons of light. If you cross at dawn, instead, the sky is a growling violet to the east. North to south, purple-gray mountains of cumulus clouds nestle close above the horizon. Purple curtains of rain sweep across the stage and the storm scolds the early riser with crackles and plucks of electricity.

Pigeon Key is a coral droplet three miles south of Marathon beneath the Seven Mile Bridge. Less than 18 inches above the shallow turquoise sea, it sits like a forgotten sentinel in some long-ended war between the Atlantic Ocean and Florida Bay. Leased by the University as a biological field station, Pigeon Key could be carpeted from sea to sea with the polyturf from the floor of Miami’s Orange Bowl stadium.

The wooden exit ramp from the overseas highway on the old trestle above is like an exit into the past. The old wooden-framed “Florida houses” on the island were once dormitories and parlor houses for the foremen on the work gangs of Henry Flagler’s Florida East Coast Railroad as it was pushed down the line of keys toward Key West. At night, the suggestions of past secrets and stories seem to scurry from crevice to crevice like palmetto bugs in the dark. As inevitable as Atlantic tides stealing into the warm shallow flats of Florida Bay, the memories come rushing back.

Iron Arrow has held a weekend outing on the Key each spring since 1972. As sea turtles follow some unfathomed map to the remote Caribbean beaches of their origins, cars begin to migrate southward from Miami. At the Key they unload Seminole jackets, diving gear, ice chests, fishing tackle, Iron Arrow members, wives, and dates. Soon, parties and barbeques litter the island like coconuts.

If you could look back through time at April 6 and 7, 1974, you would





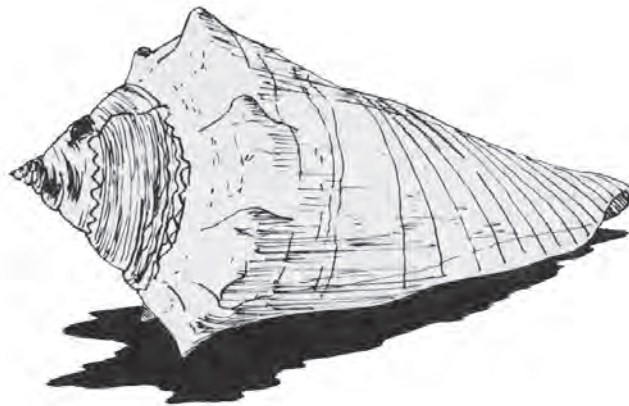
see the Key come alive. In the mudflats on the northern side of the island, purple damsels dart about as though angry at the snorkeled intruders in their watery world. Sea cucumbers and large conchs flourish in the warm, protected waters. You could hear Rhea Warren yelling that the jacks are running; or you could watch Steve Hill casting for big ones in the cool afternoon shadow of the bridge. There is John Leatherwood on the dormitory steps, inspecting an octopus in a bucket. Sunset and hunger soon arrive and it is time for a hearty seafood dinner.

Members who slept on the key that Saturday night sweltered in the heat. The cottages and houses are constructed like many of the old frame houses in Coconut Grove: to be cooled by breezes, but the breezes that night seemed as tired as the revelers. That day there appeared two waterspouts to the east against a backdrop of lightning and rain.

The weekend of April 19, 1975, found the Iron Arrow clan of the Seminole Nation again gathered at Pigeon Key; this time, on the bicentennial of Paul Revere's ride and the Battles of Lexington and Concord.

That bicentennial Saturday, there was barbequed chicken, corn-on-the-cob, baked beans, and Old Florida Rum. Chef Hal Barkas was presented with a Seminole apron for the occasion. Bill Vaught was there along with Matt Cohen and Joe Mancuso. Thad Koch made his first visit to the Key. Members enjoyed milk and meat from a coconut that had nearly fallen on Sid Weisburd's head. Bryce Dunham, Carl McKenry and Tim Choate talked of boats and of fish that





got away.

In the center of the island, a large old guest house huddles as though it were the last surviving member of its species. Today's architects no longer specify Dade County Pine. The frame structure itself has become a relic of another time, along with the great awnings and hurricane shutters. And inside one bedroom of this old frame house (set up high off the key on concrete blocks) persists a tradition nearly forgotten through the years: the wooden blades of an overhead fan to stir the thick, tropical air. The atmosphere is reminiscent of Joan Crawford in "Rain" or an old Humphrey Bogart movie.

On the rest of the upper keys, on the land itself, the hand of man has left its ugly mark. The scars are worst where the vegetation has been scraped and scoured away from the white, glaring rock. Only the Caribbean blue of the sea and the relentless tyranny of the sun restore the grandeur that was once the upper keys. But, Pigeon Key is a breezy, forgotten outpost of architecture and lifestyles long gone by.

James Hutchinson is a renowned artist in South Florida who has been commissioned by the University of Miami to paint 50 oils on canvas of the Seminole Indians, their history and their culture. In 1973, Iron Arrow contrib-



THE JAMES HUTCHINSON FUND

uted \$500.00 to the fund to finance this project. The plan to preserve Seminole culture in art was first born at the University of Florida at Gainesville but was dying there when the concept was rescued by UM's Vice President for Financial Affairs, Eugene Cohen. A message from Dr. Henry King Stanford best describes the University's interest in the project and its objectives: "As we prepare for the bicentennial year of the signing of the Declaration of Independence we have been looking more deeply into the roots of our heritage. In the process we have been rediscovering the North American Indian. With it has come new appreciation of his achievements and culture, and his place in our national life.

"We have begun to realize also that the last vestiges of that life are about to be lost. Relatively few of the Indians survive. In most cases they live far from their ancestral homes and have lost contact with their own roots. In Florida only some 1,500 Seminoles remain. Though their ancestors came to Florida two centuries ago, this is only the last in a series of refuges. Although they live in comparative isolation they are about to be overwhelmed by South Florida's rapid growth.

"The University of Miami is proud to be one of the sponsors of this community-wide project to preserve Seminole history and culture in a collection of paintings by Jim Hutchinson. The University of Miami Lowe [Art] Museum is to be the legal owner, but in reality will be acting as the custodian of a collection that belongs to the people of the state and the nation."¹²⁵

The paintings cover a period from approximately 1720 to 1965. The subjects fall into three historical subdivisions, described as follows:

1. Settlement took place when small bands from neighboring states came to northern Florida during the early 1700s and after the Creek War of 1813 -14. The artist will portray the different types of dwellings, clothing, weapons, tools, and town communities. One painting depicting the two-story log granary and log cabin home is already in the collection.
2. War, the most spectacular era of Seminole history, will include paintings of Osceola stabbing the Peace Treaty at Payne's Landing, the Dade massacre, Billy Bowlegs, the escape of Polly Parker at Cedar Key, Micanopy, raid on the trading store, ambush of white settler's oxen wagon, the slaying of Charlie Emathla, Alligator's escape from Fort Marion in St. Augustine,

¹²⁵ Stanford, Henry King, remarks in the Special Exhibit Booklet, Hutchinson Fund Exhibit, Brockway Hall, November 10, 1974.

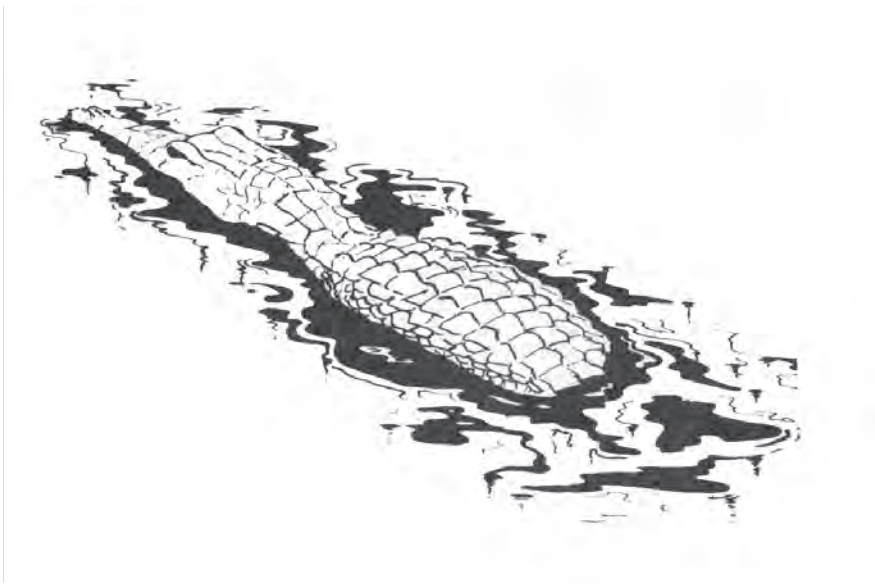




the death of Osceola in Fort Moultrie, Wildcat, retreat to the swamps, removal by steamboat to Oklahoma, flight by canoes to the Bahamas, and the destruction of Billy Bowleg's camp which led to the third Seminole War.

3. Peace, the period since 1842, will show the Seminole adjustment to the Everglades; the chickee dwelling and cook shed, canoe building, farming the interiors of hammocks, hunter camp in the 'glades, Charlie Cypress, Wheel of Life, herb doctor Annie Tommie, washday, Billy Bowlegs III, making sofkee, the Indian cowboy, blessing the medicine bundle, boar hunt, fire in the 'glades, trapping alligator, bear hunt at the site of Billy Bowlegs III's birth, and an everyday camp scene.¹²⁶

Many of the canvases have already been completed and several are on display in the Office of the President in the Ashe Administration Building. Others are intermittently displayed in the Lowe Art Museum on campus. In terms of quality and in sheer quantity, this collection will surely vault Hutchinson into the company of George Catlin and Frederick Remington as one of the major painters of the American Indian in this country. The paintings of Osceola stabbing the peace treaty at Payne's Landing, of Josie Billie, the Medicine Man, with his wheel



¹²⁶ Special Exhibit Booklet, Hutchinson Fund Exhibition, Brockway Hall, November 10, 1974.





of life, and of Annie Tommie, the mother of Tony Tommie, are canvases closely bound to the traditions of Iron Arrow.

Upon receipt of the tribe's contribution to the fund in 1973, Hutchinson addressed the following note to Iron Arrow:

March 30, 1973

Dear Chief Rhea Warren,

Mr. Robinson of the Robinson Galleries, Inc. has just informed me of your organization's generous donation to the James Hutchinson Fund.

I am doubly grateful for this gesture because I know you had this money earmarked for your own important project. I want to assure you that these funds will be put to a positive use in my work on the history of the Florida Seminoles.

Please extend my thanks to everyone in the Iron Arrow Society.

Sincerely,
(signed) James Hutchinson

The showing of the initial paintings was held in Brockway Hall, Sunday, November 10, 1974. A second exhibition featuring the first 22 completed canvases was held November 2, 1975.

In 1973, a palm blight known as "lethal yellowing" began moving northward from the Florida Keys into the mainland area of the state as far north as the Palm Beaches. The disease is fatal to the trees afflicted and at this is writing, no cure has been found. For a time, scientists feared coconut palms would become extinct in Florida. Subsequent experiments showed that injections of Terramycin into the trunks of the trees several times a year could arrest the disease in afflicted trees and help protect those palms not yet infected. Because of the many endangered trees at the University of Miami, Iron Arrow undertook





LETHAL YELLOWING

two projects to help save the trees and preserve the beauty of the campus. On Sunday, November 24, an Iron Arrow member, Joe Shaw, with the assistance of Rhea Warren and John Benedict, injected the UM palm trees. Subsequently, Shaw has proceeded, on his own, to have the trees re-injected on schedule. A letter to the alumni office of December 26, 1974, explained that “. . . under the auspices of Iron Arrow, we have injected, with Terramycin, all palms that are susceptible on campus. The total number treated was 77, which transcribed into the going rate of commercial treatment represents a cost of \$8.00 per palm.”¹²⁷

Our second response to the problem of the palm blight involved under planting the susceptible varieties of coconut palms with a blight-resistant variety from Malaysia. Iron Arrow, in cooperation with the University of Miami Alumni Association and its contribution, assisted in planting 200 of the resistant trees on the campus.

A newsletter written by Steve Hill in December 1971, reminded members that “on January 8, 1972, there will be an all day outing for Iron Arrow members and their families at the home of Tim Choate at Islamorada. During the day, tours will be given of Lignum Vitae Key. These tours will present a marvelous opportunity for members, et al., to visit a unique Florida key, whose ecological and historical values are incalculable.”

Earlier that fall, Rhea Warren had announced that the tribe had raised \$850.00 for its Lignum Vitae project. “This amount is sufficient to begin the opening of the large Indian mound. Dr. John Hall, who is supervising the dig,



¹²⁷ Shaw, Joseph, letter to the University Of Miami Alumni Office, December 26, 1974.





LIGNUM VITAE



will be with us to explain how the dig is going to be worked. Iron Arrow members from the Biology Department will fill us in on the ecological aspects of the island. An ornithological field trip is planned with Dr. Oscar Owre. The survey of the flora on the key, which was named after the Lignum Vitae tree, will be conducted by Dr. Taylor Alexander.”¹²⁸

The eventual \$2,000 the tribe hoped to raise, was to finance Dr. Hall’s archaeological dig and thereby reconstruct the ethnology of the Indian culture of the key. Of peculiar interest in the project was the fact that “remains of Indians found during a surface investigation of the mound, conducted in 1949, indicated that the tribe that produced the mound was of unusual stature. The women were apparently six feet ten inches tall and the men seven feet seven!”¹²⁹

This project was the outgrowth of an earlier project (1969) to start a collection of literature, information, and artifacts dealing with the Seminole Indians. In this case, Iron Arrow’s long-range goal was to establish the largest such collection ever assembled. It was hoped that the collection would include taped interviews, photographs, and films of the Indians in addition to artifacts. The project was diverted, however, by the opportunity provided by the planned study of Lignum Vitae Key.

What happened next was beyond the control of Iron Arrow. The state,

¹²⁸ Iron Arrow Newsletter, November, 1971.





urged by a conservation group called “The Nature Conservancy,” purchased Lignum Vitae Key for the purpose of preserving its unique natural environment, which includes “one of the largest stands of West Indian virgin tropical flora left in the continental United States.”¹³⁰ Subsequent to the purchase, the state determined to postpone or hold in permanent abeyance the proposed archaeological excavation of the mound.

Thus, neither the Seminole collection nor the Lignum Vitae project was completed. The funds already collected, however, were diverted to similar and worthwhile purposes. Part was donated to the James Hutchinson Fund which, after all, proposed to accomplish through art that which had originally been planned through literature and artifacts.

A TYPICAL YEAR

On April 24, 1975, Chief John Benedict mailed an Iron Arrow bulletin briefly summarizing the tribe’s activities during the preceding year. The list was four pages long. These are excerpts:

The Homecoming Reception, held at President Stanford’s new home on Old Cutler Road, drew the largest crowd ever present. Over 300 members and guests attended the event following the Homecoming parade.

The fourth annual Underprivileged Children’s football game was



the UM-Pacific game. Over 90 children were treated to hot dogs, coke, and ice cream by the tribe. The game proved enjoyable as the Hurricanes ran over Pacific, 35-7.

For the first time, we manned all of the phones one night at the annual Alumni Loyalty Fund phone campaign. Members obtained pledges of \$7,080, a 50 percent increase over our previous year’s high.

As a culmination of our Homecoming activities, nearly 150 members and tappees in attendance at the game participated in greeting the team in pregame and half-time lineups.

¹²⁹ The Miami Hurricane, July 9, 1971.

¹³⁰ The Miami Hurricane, March 3, 1972.





Iron Arrow sponsored the injection of palm trees on campus in an effort to save some of the trees from the palm blight. Seventy-seven trees were injected, but further treatments will be required.

New uniforms for the Band of the Hour were being purchased last summer. The tribe was responsible for raising \$960.00.

Prior to the fall semester, Iron Arrow aided in the sale of football season tickets. During the week-long campaign, 54 season tickets (valued at \$44.00 each) were sold.

The first Iron Arrow Seminole Scholarship was awarded in October. Ron Scott, a senior drama major, whose Osage Indian name is Running Deer, faced the distinct possibility of leaving school because of [lack of funds for] tuition. The scholarship enabled him to complete his education and graduate in December of 1974. The Seminole Scholarship Fund is one of the few instances in the nation where a collegiate organization offers a scholarship to the American Indian. The fund presently contains \$2,000 due to the efforts of members Julian Cole and Luther Evans.

In addition to the scholarship awards, a tuition waiver for an Indian student has been given by the University. Upon request of the tribe, University officials considered the proposal, and Dr. Stanford announced the waiver at our Homecoming luncheon.





A CELEBRATION

On the occasion of its fiftieth anniversary, Iron Arrow Honor Society hosted a golden anniversary celebration at the Riviera Country Club of Coral Gables. That evening, October 31, 1976, was the last time that most of the surviving founders of Iron Arrow would gather with younger members from the Tribe's first fifty years. Among the founders present were Johnnie McGuire, Bob Fink, Norman Ted Kennedy, and Francis S. Houghtaling.

Howard Osceola attended the celebration. Francis Houghtaling was awarded the Bowman Foster Ashe In-Memoriam Honor by Chief John Benedict, and Iron Arrow member Mike Braz played piano during the reception, including such 1920's/1930's classics as: "The Sheik of Araby," "Perfidia", and Irving Berlin's "What'll I Do?"

You can recapture a sense of the anniversary and of the 1920's Iron Arrow by playing a tape or CD soundtrack of the Robert Redford movie, "The Great Gatsby." (By the way, do you know what Robert Redford's closing lines were at the end of his recent movie, "Havana"?) (Answer: "This is hurricane country.")

Film from the evening shows a table full of Iron Arrow historical memorabilia, the Iron Arrow flag, membership plaques, scrapbooks, and a three foot long photo of the founding nine. Among members in attendance were: Armando "Stitch" Vari, Bryce Dunham, Sid Weisburd, Mike Braz, Thad Koch, Joe Mancuso, Drew Vella, Steve Hill, Henry Minich, Henry King Stanford, Joe Shaw, Randolph Femmer, Bob Rosen, Michael Leone, Dave Brown, Walt Kichefski, and Clive Shrader. And, speaking of Clive Shrader, he probably summed up this unique celebration best when he said that he remembers the evening banquet as, "the finest social event in the history of Iron Arrow."

The Tribe's videotape, UM's Living History: Iron Arrow, highlights film footage from the evening, including Houghtaling's receipt of the Ashe In-Memoriam and a portrait presentation to President Henry King Stanford. The video history closes with a short, moving scene showing Johnnie McGuire signaling "Number One" to those of us viewing the film down through the years.

That Homecoming week, 1976, also featured a luncheon and reception for all of Iron Arrow's past officers at Howard Osceola's village at Twenty Mile Bend in the Everglades. And film footage of UM's homecoming parade down Miracle Mile in Coral Gables shows Francis Houghtaling, Rhea Warren, and John Benedict riding in a carriage, while other Iron Arrow members, such as Michael Leone and Drew Vella, are riding on the sideboards of 1920-era Model T Fords.





EPILOGUE

Having recounted the history of our tribe, we would be remiss to close without comment on its future. We have observed several themes or principles we believe underlie the success of Iron Arrow.

1. There is power in the Indian tradition. Iron Arrow is unique among honor societies in drawing its trappings and traditions from the American Indian cultures. Not only were the leaders of these tribes eloquent orators, invoking magnificent imagery, but the cultures themselves were rooted in nature and its cycles. Thus, Iron Arrows find their traditions eloquent and profoundly moving. Unlike societies which draw upon Greek mythology for traditions, Iron Arrow draws upon wilderness and its values, color and richness unexcelled.

2. A part of Iron Arrow's success rests upon the balance it maintains between intense visibility and impenetrable secrecy. The ceremonial jackets, the drum, the Arrow, the plaque, the firebowl, the statue of Ashe, the colorful tapping ritual; these have been separate innovations. But they have evolved such complementary functions that their combined power is one dramatic unity. In this regard, the twice-annual tapping display is critical to the "sense of presence" the campus community has regarding Iron Arrow. The other side of the coin is the element of mystery. What goes on during Iron Arrow meetings, especially selection meetings? More mysterious still, what are the initiation ceremonies like? The speculation engendered by such mysteries is a powerful ally of the IA phenomenon.

3. The great significance of being selected for membership in Iron Arrow is in the knowledge that one's selection was unanimous. Other honor societies abound for which selection is automatic with the attainment of a specified criterion. Still others elect their members on bases far below unanimity. But the honor of the membership bestowed by Iron Arrow is compelling, for its members have passed the severest tests. To lessen that standard is to lessen the honor.

Unanimity was also the tradition of the American Indian.¹³¹ IA must maintain critical unanimity, not a perfunctory or apathetic endorsement. Temerity or "inoffensiveness" during the process can serve only to weaken Iron Arrow, not to strengthen it. The absence of argument or contention during the selection process should alarm us, for such debate helps ensure the focused judgement needed to remain truly the highest honor attained at our University.

As years come and go, there are inevitable changes in student interests and pursuits which serve to accommodate the "spirit of the times." When such changes occur, it may be difficult to apply accustomed standards for member-

¹³¹ Josephy, Alvin M., *The Indian Heritage of America*.





ship in the changed campus situation. Although the initiation ritual does much to define those unchanging qualities which signify leadership, there is another standard that may be useful in bridging the effects of time on selection standards: members may compare the “number of man hours” times “impact” of a nominee with those traditionally required for membership.

4. Another source of IA strength is that, unlike other types of tap societies, Every member always has a vote: for life. The Iron Arrow leader is never disenfranchised; his participation is always welcome.

5. The tribal tradition is also enhanced by that one arduous, symbolic event shared between Iron Arrows and no others: the initiation ritual. Care must be taken to maintain both its secrecy and its quality. The secrecy appears to be maintained instinctively.

The quality of the initiation varies from year to year. At best, the ritual hits with the force of a dramatic stage production; which is as it should be. At worst, it is a disappointment to all concerned. Those who administer the initiation should remember that it marks the tappees’ first introduction to the tribe, its principles, its history and ideals. As such, it is an occasion for solemnity.

The Medicine Man must realize that no dramatic impact is possible without practice. Participants should have dramatic talent and polish their performance. Non-ritual conversations and distractions should be prevented. The ritual also suffers from extremes. If too few or too many members administer it, the impact is weakened. Administering the initiation can be a moving emotional event in which all participants renew their spiritual ties with the wil-





derness. To achieve this, however, requires at least as much care and planning as the tappings and the luncheons.

6. All of our members are leaders. But not all are able to adopt Iron Arrow as their sole responsibility. Nevertheless, Iron Arrow always has needed and always will need at least one or two members, officers or advisors, whose association with the tribe will provide it with protection and continuity. It is only from such members of long association that the perpetuation of accumulated wisdom and traditions can be ensured.

The University of Miami may be viewed as a specialized, tightly interwoven ecosystem. That ecosystem has always harbored a unique species of honor society, an organism of rare beauty. By its nature, however, the organism cannot survive apart from its unique environment and exists nowhere else in the world. Therefore, Iron Arrow will be forever an endangered species. Only recently has man begun to realize that even small fluctuations in a tightly interwoven ecosystem may have large, unforeseen, and adverse effects on organisms whose lives are delicately adapted to that system. Thus, small, seemingly insignificant changes in the University community can have profound effects on Iron Arrow and its overall viability.

This metaphor defines the position of Iron Arrow and its need for a figure to protect it and guarantee its continuity. The society has almost always had such a figure. Bowman Ashe in its early arduous years, Thurston Adams for nearly two decades. During the one time in its history that such a sustaining figure was absent, when Ashe was away during World War II, Iron Arrow was comatose.

Ideally, this role must be fulfilled by a member whose association with the tribe has been extensive, because continuity is one quality that cannot be provided by student members of the society. It is our hope that this history and discussion will help those to whom the tribe's future is entrusted.

If Iron Arrow were on many campuses, we could be less concerned with the ongoing state of its health, for on one campus or another, we would be strong. But we have rejected that option and have chosen to maintain personally and for ourselves the high standards Bowman Ashe set for us. Having made that decision, we must accept the burden of responsibility it places upon us to ensure the survival of that which we love and treasure. To that purpose, and to Asi-yaholo, the black-drink singer, and to Bowman Foster Ashe, this history is respectfully dedicated.

